

Yue Chen

Curriculum Vitae

Research Interests

Language Acquisition, Language Processing, Multilingualism, Cognition

Education

University of Southern California, Los Angeles, CA

2024 - Present **Ph.D. Linguistics**

University of Southern California, Los Angeles, CA

2024 - 2026 **M.A. Linguistics**

Thesis: Who Is Whom? Influences of Theta Roles and Discourse Topicality on the Resolution of Mandarin Reflexives

Committee: Elsi Kaiser (Chair), Zuzanna Fuchs, Andrew Simpson, Jun Lyu

The University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)

2023 **B.A. Linguistics and Psychology**, Minor in Comparative Literature

Honors Thesis (Linguistics): Acquisition of English Reflexive Pronouns: Evidence from Naturalistic Observation

Advisor: Catherine M. Sandhofer

Honors Thesis (Psychology): Unveiling the Parallel Function Hypothesis on Personal Pronouns: A Corpus Analysis Utilizing Eye-Tracking Data

Advisor: Jesse Harris

Summer School

2025 The North American Summer School for Logic, Language and Information (NASSLLI '25), University of Washington, Seattle, Online

2023 /L+/ International Summer / Winter School on Language Acquisition, University of Potsdam, Online

Scholarship and Awards

2026 Travel Award for HSP 2026

2025 Paula Menyuk Award for BUCLD50

2023 UCLA College of Letters and Science Latin Honors: Cum Laude

2023 UCLA Linguistics Department Honors

2023 UCLA College of Letters and Science College Honors

2023 Rose Gilbert in Memory of Maggie Gilbert Scholarship

2022 UCLA/Keck Humanistic Inquiry Undergraduate Research Award (Keck)

Journal Publications

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1. Fuchs, Z., Kealey, E., Eldem, E., Mermelstein, L., Pham, L., Runova, A., **Chen, Y.**, Oguz, M., Hong, S., Pan, C., Subramony, J., (2025). Measuring Adult Heritage Language Lexical Proficiency for Studies on Facilitative Processing of Gender. In O. Ivanova & O. Loureda (Eds.), *Language Processing in Spanish Heritage Speakers* [Special issue]. *Languages*, 10(8), 189. <https://doi.org/10.3390/languages10080189>
2. Mai, Z., Wong, P. C., Matthews, S., Yip, V., Liao, H., Nie, J., **Chen, Y.** (2025). Zhuang-Mandarin bilingual children in rural China and the role of grandparental input in early bilingualism. *PloS one*, 20(6), e0326671.

Conference Proceedings

1. **Chen, Y.** (in press). From *um* to Words: The Role of Disfluency Interactions in Shaping Early Language Development. In *Proceedings of 50th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD)*
2. **Chen, Y.**, Shang, M., & Mai, Z. (2025). Cross-Linguistic Influence and Developmental Patterns in Reflexive Pronoun Use Among Monolingual, Bilingual, and Trilingual Children. In *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society* (Vol. 47). <https://escholarship.org/uc/item/7xs6k5h2>

Selected Conference Presentations and Posters

1. **Chen, Y.**, Wan, E., Balarin de Siqueira, Du, Y., Fuchs, Z., (**submitted to BUCLD51**). Some Classifiers Come Easier Than Others: Classifier Learning in Mandarin-English Bilingual Children.
2. **Chen, Y.**, Wan, E., Xiao, Y., Balarin de Siqueira, C., Noh, S., Fuchs, Z., Yang, Y., Wu, H., Du, Y., (**submitted to CSHA**). Classifiers in Bilingual Mandarin-English Child Language Assessment.
3. **Chen, Y.**, Lyu, J., Kaiser, E. (2026, September). On the Interplay of Topicality and Perspectival Information in Reference Resolution: Insights from Anaphoric Reflexives. **[Talk]** Discourse Expectations: Theoretical, Experimental and Computational Perspectives (DETEC 2026), Utrecht University, Utrecht, the Netherlands.
4. **Chen, Y.**, Lyu, J., Kaiser, E. (2026, September). Topic and Experiencer Both Matter: Multiple Cues in Mandarin Reflexive Resolution. **[Poster]** Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP 2026), Saarland University, Saarbrücken, Germany.
5. Charan, D., **Chen, Y.**, Grachek, D., Huang, P.-H., He, M., Hsu, H., Li, J., Wang, Y., & Breiss, C. (2026, April). *A large-scale corpus investigation of Italian troncamento*. **[Poster]** Southern California April Meeting on Phonology (SCAMP), University of Southern California, Los Angeles, CA.
6. **Chen, Y.** (2026, March). *Too Much Information? Mandarin Classifiers from Humans to LLMs*. **[Poster]** 39th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP 39), Cambridge, MA.
7. **Chen, Y.** (2025, November). *From 'Um' to Words: The Role of Disfluency Interactions in Shaping Early Language Development*. **[Poster] (One of the top-rated student submissions; Paula Menyuk Award)** 50th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD), Boston, MA.

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8. **Chen, Y.**, Mai, Z., Shang, M., (2025, July). *Cross-Linguistic Influence and Developmental Patterns in Reflexive Pronoun Use Among Monolingual, Bilingual, and Trilingual Children*. [Poster] CogSci 2025, San Francisco, CA.
9. Fuchs, Z., Kealey, E., Eldem, E., Mermelstein, L., Pham, L., Runova, A., Hong, S., Oguz, M., **Chen, Y.**, Pan, C., Subramony, J., (2025, June). *Predicting facilitative processing of gender in Heritage Spanish using measures of lexical proficiency*. 16th Heritage Language Research Institute (HLRI), [Poster] Madison, WI.
10. **Chen, Y.**, Mai, Z., Chen, Y., (2024, November). *Employing Machine Learning and Language Models to Differentiate Language Patterns in Mandarin-Speaking Preschoolers with Autism Spectrum Disorder*. [Poster] California Meeting on Psycholinguistics 7 (CAMP7), San Diego, CA.
11. **Chen, Y.**, Su, Y., (2024, November). *Exploring Reflexive Pronoun Development and Usage in Mandarin-Learning Toddlers: A Comparative Study of ASD and TD Groups*. [Poster] California Meeting on Psycholinguistics 7 (CAMP7), San Diego, CA.
12. **Chen, Y.**, Mai, Z., Hu, X., Shang, M., (2024, July). *Reflexive pronouns in Chinese-learning monolingual, bilingual, and trilingual toddlers, and their parental input*. [Poster] Child Language Symposium 2024, Newcastle, UK.
13. **Chen, Y.** (2024, May). *Unveiling the Parallel Function Hypothesis on Personal Pronouns: A Corpus Analysis Utilizing Eye-Tracking Data*. [Poster] The 11th Conference on Language, Discourse, and Cognition, Taipei, Taiwan.
14. **Chen, Y.** (2023, February). *Acquisition of English Reflexive Pronouns: Evidence from Naturalistic Observation*. [Poster], 22nd Meeting of the Texas Linguistics Society, Austin, TX.

Undergraduate Publications

1. **Chen, Y.**, Neer, E., Zhang, E., Sandhofer, C.M., (2024). Acquisition of English Reflexive Pronouns: Evidence from Naturalistic Observation. *UCLA Undergraduate Psychology Journal*, 11(1), 6-16.

Teaching Experience

TAs at University of Southern California

Fall 2025, Fall 2026: **LING115 Language and Society**

Instructor: Professor Andrew Simpson

Spring 2026:

LING 385: Human Language as Computation

Instructor: Khalil Iskarous

Working Manuscript

- Who Feels, Who Causes? Empathy Locus and Discourse Coherence in Large Language Models

Work Experiences

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2023 - 2024 **Linguistics Research Assistant for Professor Maggie Mai from CUHK**
Involved in multiple research projects, including modeling, CHILDES corpus building, early multilingual development and heritage language acquisition and processing, responsible for literature review, manuscript preparation, coordination between different laboratories and academics, transcription using CLAN and CHAT, and data collection.

Lab Experiences

2024 - **Psycholinguistics of Mono- and Multilingualism Lab (PoMMLab)**
Involved in stimulus creation, in charge of data organization.
Principal Investigator: Zuzanna Fuchs

2021- 2023 **Language Processing Lab**
Involved in phonetics stimulus creation by using Praat, in charge of data organization, running eye-tracking, pupillometry, self-paced reading, and reading reaction experiments both in person and online.
Principal Investigator: Jesse Harris

2021- 2023 **Language and Cognition Development Lab**
Involved in Research design, in charge of critical thinking and methodology development for social cue projects, data (behavior) coding, lexicon building for each transcript, utterance by utterance transcription of each video by using CLAN, data organization, data analysis, creating RA manuals, new RA-training, and literature review of articles related to social cues and parent-child interactions.
Principal Investigator: Catherine M. Sandhofer
Ph.D. Student Supervisors: Emily Neer and Erjing Zhang

Summer 2022 **Language Acquisition Lab**
In charge of subject scheduling and recruitment, organizing timeslot, and helping run in-person infant preferential-looking paradigm experiments.
Principal Investigator: Megha Sundara and Laurel Perkins

Public and University Events

Winter 2023 **Invited Presenter**, Bruin Day for Admitted Transfers, UCLA
A presentation on my current honors thesis, sharing insights from my undergraduate research journey as a first-generation college student at UCLA. The session will include a Q&A on conducting research and accessing resources as an undergraduate.

Academic Service

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2025 – 2026: **Colloquium Coordinator (with Yingyu Su)**, Graduate Students in Linguistics (GSiL), University of Southern California (USC)

2025: **Conference Support**, Workshop on Theoretical East Asian Linguistics 14 (TEAL-14), University of Southern California (USC)

Reviewer: CAMP7, CAMP8, SAIS 2025, CogSci 2025, CogSci 2026, AMCIS 2025, PACIS 2025

Volunteer

UCLA Undergraduate Research Peer Mentor
Child Rescue Organization - China (Non-Profit)
Exploring Your Universe (EYU) - UCLA Psychology Department

Skills

Language: Mandarin Chinese (Native), Wu Chinese (Native), English, Spanish, Italian

Programming skills: C/C++, Python (NumPy, PyTorch, Transformers), MATLAB, R

Data presentation and analysis: SPSS, MATLAB, LaTeX, Praat, ELAN, CLAN, Qualtrics, SynthWorks, Rezonator, PCibex

Other Services and Memberships

Present	Member of the Linguistics Society of America
Present	Cognitive Science Society
Present	Human Sentence Processing